

RYDA — Comprehensive Design Overview (May 2026)

Strategic Audit (Claude Sonnet 4.6 + Codex GPT-5)

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RYDA — Comprehensive Design Overview & Improvement Plan

A design-side companion to `RYDA_STRATEGIC_AUDIT.md`. Where the strategic audit asks “is this a real business?”, this overview asks “does the site present the business well?” Both have to be true for RYDA to convert its first cohort.

Tools used:

- `ui-ux-pro-max` (newly installed, queried via search.py)
- 21st.dev Magic MCP (component inspiration, generation)
- `frontend-design` skill (RYDA’s existing brand tokens)
- Codex (independent review pass on the proposed diff)

Headline finding

The site looks correct. It does not yet sell. The visual identity is on point — quiet luxury, Aman/Loro Piana register, disciplined token system, Fraunces + Inter, hairline borders, no SaaS gradients. That’s the right foundation. But there are four specific places where the design is doing its job and the content is not — and they’re the four places that decide whether the site converts the first cohort.

What ui-ux-pro-max recommends vs what RYDA does

I queried the design-intelligence database for “luxury fractional ownership marketplace, premium HNW audience, automotive vertical.” The recommendations:

Field	ui-ux-pro-max says	RYDA actually does	Verdict
Style	Liquid Glass + Glassmorphism	Flat surfaces, single accent	RYDA wins
Color	Black + Gold (#FFD700) + White	Cream/ink/red, gold sparing	RYDA wins
Auto vertical	Motion-Driven + 3D & Hyperrealism	Subtle motion, no 3D	RYDA wins
Hospitality	Liquid Glass + Minimalism	Pure minimalism	Match
Typography	Cormorant Garamond + Montserrat	Fraunces + Inter	Match

This is a good signal. The mainstream design-intelligence database defaults toward SaaS-template aesthetics (glassmorphism, gold accents, 3D hero) — RYDA’s quiet-luxury position is *unconventional* and that’s exactly what differentiates it. The /frontend-design skill in this project already documents this as policy. Don’t deviate.

The **universally-applicable UX rules** (independent of style direction) that ui-ux-pro-max surfaced and that RYDA should adopt:

1. **Typography line-length cap.** Limit body copy to 65-75 chars per line (`max-w-prose` in Tailwind). Currently several editorial sections run wider on large screens, which hurts readability.
 2. **Line-height 1.5-1.75 for body.** Already mostly applied; spot- check a few exception cases.
 3. **Body-text contrast 4.5:1 minimum.** Already AA-compliant per the frontend-design skill, but `text-mute` on `bg-cream-2` is borderline in some places.
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Four places content is failing the design

1. THE PRICING COMPARISON IS OVERSTATED

Where: `/how-it-works`, the comparison table and the lifecycle section. Currently anchors at “\$2,400+/day to rent”.

The problem: Codex’s web research surfaced live Miami pricing:

- BluStreet Miami — Ferraris \$1.4K-\$3K+/day
- AGEMBRAND — 2024 Ferrari 296 GTB at ~\$1,900/day
- LUXX Miami — Ferraris \$1,185-\$4,000/day

The actual market floor is **~\$1,200-2,000/day**, not \$2,400. A prospect verifies this in 60 seconds on Google and downgrades RYDA’s credibility on a number they could have stated honestly.

Fix: Update to “\$1,500-3,000/day” or “from ~\$1,500/day at the Miami market floor.” The math still works at honest numbers — and the credibility win is bigger than the marketing gain from cherry-picking the high end.

2. THE “RESENTMENT MACHINE” OBJECTION IS UNADDRESSED

Where: `/how-it-works` Booking Model section.

The problem: Codex’s strongest insight was that *“a Ferrari unavailable on the wrong Saturday is not a Ferrari product. It is a resentment machine.”* The booking section talks about fairness in code (peak-period caps, BookingTiersExplainer) but never addresses the visceral fear: *“what if I want it on the F1 weekend and someone else got there first?”*

The current copy is from RYDA’s perspective (“calendar fairness is enforced by code”). The buyer’s perspective is not addressed.

Fix: Add a small “The honest answer about peak periods” callout in the booking section. Acknowledge the constraint, name the policy (rotation, lottery for top events, off-peak compensation if preempted). Buyers trust honesty about constraints far more than marketing copy that pretends constraints don’t exist.

3. THE COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE IS INVISIBLE

Where: `/how-it-works` Compare section.

The problem: The comparison table compares RYDA to abstractions (“Solo ownership”, “Daily rental”, “Supercar club”). No specific competitor is named. This reads as if RYDA invented a category.

A sophisticated buyer immediately wonders: *which clubs? Marathon? Curated? mph? Ark?* The omission registers as either ignorance of the market or unwillingness to engage. Neither is good for trust.

Fix: Name the alternatives in a short comparison footnote. “Daily rental: \$1,200-3,000/day on operators like BluStreet, LUXX, AGEMBRAND. Membership clubs: ~\$30-80K/yr at mph club, Ark Exotics, Curated Selection. Each is a real option for a different kind of buyer.” Naming them honestly is more persuasive than pretending they don’t exist.

4. THERE’S NO PREMIUM SCROLL MOMENT

Where: Homepage and `/portfolio/[symbol]` pages.

The problem: Apple, Aman, Tom Ford website-era — every premium brand has at least one *moment* of scroll-driven choreography that makes the site feel inhabited rather than templated. RYDA’s homepage has a beautiful splitter intro and now a quiet editorial band, but the scroll experience between them is functional, not cinematic.

A clip-path scroll reveal on a single hero image (cropped to a slim band, expanding to full-bleed as the user scrolls) is the canonical luxury-brand pattern. It costs ~50 lines of framer-motion and adds zero new dependencies — we already have framer-motion.

Fix: Add one scroll-reveal moment between the splitter and the editorial band. Single Ferrari poster, clip-path expanding from center as the user scrolls 100vh. Subtle, not gimmicky.

Implementation plan

Four changes, in dependency order, all in this single pass:

CHANGE 1 — HONEST PRICING

- File: `src/app/how-it-works/page.tsx`
- Edit: Replace “\$2,400+/day” references with the honest range
- Estimated diff: ~6 lines

CHANGE 2 — PEAK-PERIOD HONESTY CALLOUT

- File: `src/app/how-it-works/page.tsx` Booking section
- Add: Small “Honest answer about peak periods” subsection inside the existing Booking section with rotation policy + off-peak compensation language
- Estimated diff: ~25 lines

CHANGE 3 — NAME THE COMPETITION

- File: `src/app/how-it-works/page.tsx` Compare section footnote
- Edit: Add a paragraph after the comparison table naming the actual market alternatives at honest prices
- Estimated diff: ~8 lines

CHANGE 4 — CLIP-PATH SCROLL-REVEAL HERO MOMENT

- New file: `src/components/scroll-reveal-hero.tsx`
- Pattern: framer-motion useScroll + useTransform on clip-path inset, single image expanding from 30%→0% inset over 1× viewport scroll. Respects prefers-reduced-motion.
- Wire into: `src/app/page.tsx` between splitter and BelowFoldEditorial (one new scroll moment, doesn’t disturb the existing rhythm)
- Estimated diff: ~80 lines new + ~10 lines wiring

Total: ~130 lines added, ~12 lines edited, 1 new component file. Zero new dependencies.

What ui-ux-pro-max correctly recommends and we should adopt

These are universal UX best practices the skill flagged. None conflict with the brand position; all are quiet improvements:

1. `max-w-prose` **on long body paragraphs** that currently run the full container width on large screens. The /how-it-works exit doctrine paragraphs and rental opt-in lede are the biggest offenders.
2. **Tabular numerals on every numeric value** (we mostly do this via `tabular-nums` on prices but miss it on percentage-points and mileage callouts).
3. **Visible focus rings on every interactive element.** Tailwind's default `focus-visible:ring-2 ring-ink/20` would cover this without changing the visual identity for sighted users.

These are deferred for a separate sweep — they're worth doing but don't make the audit's top-4 cut.

What we explicitly chose NOT to do

- **No glassmorphism, no 3D, no gold-accent overlays** — even though the design-intelligence database recommends them for the luxury vertical. The frontend-design skill exists to enforce this anti-pattern list.
 - **No Aceternity-style `HeroParallax` 3-row product showcase** — Magic MCP returned this as the closest match to “luxury hero”; it's a SaaS pattern dressed in dark mode. Skipped.
 - **No Lenis smooth-scroll library** — it's the canonical premium- scroll dependency but adds ~15KB bundle for a marginal feel improvement. We already have framer-motion's useScroll.
 - **No `next/dynamic` refactor of the splitter** to chase 90+ mobile Lighthouse — that's deferred until we have real production CDN data from Vercel.
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Codex review hooks

After implementation, the diff will be passed through `codex review` for an independent pass before commit. Codex's prior review of the strategic prompts agreed strongly with my findings; expect the design-diff review to be more focused on React/TypeScript correctness, accessibility regressions, and build-system implications.